

Lawmakers ponder unmasking ICE agents

Mass. would follow Calif.; enforcement could be an issue

By Samantha J. Gross and Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts lawmakers are considering banning federal immigration agents from wearing face

coverings while on duty — a move pushed by advocates but that some legal scholars say may amount to little more than a symbolic gesture. The state Senate's top leader said Thursday that she is "incredibly concerned" about federal immigration officials concealing their faces and would consider legislation banning the practice, voicing support for a bill that advocates have pushed.

"Residents are fearful. I mean, they think they're being kidnapped," Senate President Karen Spilka said in response to a question about the bill. "It's almost like the 1930s Germany, here in Massachusetts and across our country. And that is just not acceptable." The bill, filed in early July by Democratic Representative Jim Hawkins, would ban anyone acting on behalf of a local, state, or federal

law enforcement agency from wearing "any mask or personal disguise" while interacting with the public. The bill would allow exceptions for surgical masks or N95 respirators used for certain medical circumstances as well as members of Special Weapons and Tactics (SWAT) teams, who would be allowed to "utilize gear necessary to protect their faces from physical harm."

MASKS, Page A6

Gambling scandal shakes the NBA

Illegal betting, rigged poker games, ties to Mafia alleged; two ex-Celtics face charges

By Emma Healy
GLOBE STAFF

A gambling scandal rocked the National Basketball Association Thursday when federal authorities disclosed multiple schemes that included two former Celtics draft picks: Chauncey Billups, currently head coach of the Portland Trail Blazers, and Terry Rozier, who now plays for the Miami Heat.

Billups and Rozier face money laundering and wire fraud conspiracy charges. Former NBA player Damon Jones was also among those indicted in separate but related cases that allege conspiring with organized crime figures to run illegal sports betting and rig poker games that cheated unknowing participants out of millions of dollars.

In addition to money laundering and fraud, the charges issued to dozens of participants include extortion, robbery, and illegal gambling.

The indictments handed down by the US attorney in the Eastern District of New York include stunning details that could have come from Martin Scorsese's 1990 classic "Goodfellas," including rigged card-shuffling machines, X-ray equipment, and hidden cameras.

Authorities say 11 of the 32 people charged in the poker conspiracy were part of the infamous New York Mafia crime families — Genovese, Gambino, Bonanno, and Lucchese — serving as leaders, members, and associates.

Billups and Rozier have been put on leave by the NBA as it investigates the matter.

BETTING, Page C5



PHOTOS BY LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Connie Chapman, a tissue coordinator-dissectionist, worked in the freezer room at the Harvard Brain Tissue Resource Center at McLean Hospital in Belmont. Below, a "teaching brain" from a person with schizophrenia.

USING THEIR BRAINS

Getting precious tissue to study is hard enough for researchers, and cuts make it worse

By Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

The clock was ticking: a brain was en route.

Two workers at the Harvard Brain Tissue Resource Center hurried to prepare a bucket of dry ice and lay out gleaming scalpels, knives, and forceps for the donated human brain from a recently deceased man with Huntington's disease. The donation would arrive within the target time of 24 hours after his death; any longer and it might not be viable for researchers studying Huntington's, a devastating inherited condition that causes cognitive, psychological, and physical decline.

Once the brain arrived at their lab, the



two technicians had just two hours to dissect it and freeze the samples before the tissue warmed.

"It quite literally will melt in your hands," said Grace Nyanchoka as she handled the

spongy mass of tissue. "We try to move fast while it's still firm."

Now, the nearly 50-year-old center, located on the McLean Hospital campus in Belmont, is itself moving with urgency to stave off a possible 35 percent budget cut by the end of October that could seriously hinder its ability to obtain new donations, said Dr. Sabina Berretta, the center's director.

And that in turn could disrupt research on a number of conditions that require samples from hundreds of brains at a time.

"As a field, we're going through that material very quickly," said Steven McCarroll, who runs a Harvard lab studying conditions including schizophrenia and Huntington's dis-

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Former Celtics Terry Rozier (left) and Chauncey Billups, who is now a coach, have been placed on leave by the NBA.

Fewer Blacks and Latinos are enrolling at Harvard

By Diti Kohli and Neena Hagen
GLOBE STAFF

Harvard University enrolled fewer Black and Latino freshmen — and more Asian American students — in its incoming class this fall, a sign of a growing demographic shift at elite colleges two years after the Supreme Court scuttled race-conscious admissions.

Black students make up 8.9 percent of Harvard's 1,675 first-year students, down from 10.4 percent last fall. Another 8.5 percent of the class is Hispanic or Latino, compared to 11.8 percent a year ago. The number of Asian American students rose from 27.4 to 31.6 percent since last fall. It did not explicitly list its percentage of white students.

The numbers give an early indicator of how the end of affirmative action is affecting diversity at top colleges, experts said, even as a Globe analysis found that prestigious schools have been slower to publish enrollment data this fall.

"This will worsen over time," said Shaun Harper, an education professor at the University of Southern California. He noted that a 1996 California law that banned race in university admissions had the "same devastating effect. The enrollment decreased right away. Then the longer it went on, the worse it got."

There may be other factors as well. This was the first year since the COVID-19 pandemic that Harvard required applicants to submit standardized test scores. Some higher education watchers have

HARVARD, Page A7

The Everett 13-year-old whose ICE arrest sparked questions over police interactions with immigration authorities asked a court to forgive him, and apologized "for everything." **B1.**

The Trump administration finalized a plan to open the coastal plain of Alaska's Arctic National Wildlife Refuge to oil and gas drilling, renewing a long-simmering debate. **A5.**

Demolition of Cambridge's doomed Riverview condo building will begin in December and is set to finish in the spring. **B1.**

Turn signal

Friday: A few clouds. High 57-62. Low 43-48.

Saturday: More of the same. High 55-60. Low 41-46.

High tide: 1:35 a.m., 1:37 p.m.

Sunrise: 7:08 Sunset: 5:48

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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\$4.00



Free entry at national parks, hidden costs

Loss of key revenue squeezes them harder

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — A year ago, more than half a million people crowded into Acadia National Park in October to experience the picturesque fall foliage along the Maine coast, and it appears to be just as busy again this month — but with a major difference.

The federal government shutdown means visitors drive right past unstaffed entrance booths without having to pay the \$35 per vehicle fee. That's costing Acadia, along with national parks around the country, millions of dollars at a time when Trump administration cuts have already taken a heavy toll on the country's "crown jewels."

The 567,466 Acadia visitors in October 2024 generated an estimated \$1.5 million in fees, about 80 percent of which the park retained to help pay for projects and staff to improve it, said Eric Stiles, president of Friends of Acadia, an advocacy group. When the shutdown began on Oct. 1, the Trump administration opted to keep national parks largely accessible, although with reduced staff and services. But for unstated reasons, the National Park Service has also stopped collecting entrance fees, causing a crucial revenue



HEATHER DIEHL FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

The normal price to enter Acadia National Park is \$35. Now, with entrance booths unstaffed, it's \$0.

stream to dry up like an autumn leaf.

Compounding the problem, the parks are already tapping reserves from prior fee collections to fund skeleton staffs and operations, a move that park advocates said is illegal and compounds the future funding problem.

It all means the impact of the second-longest shutdown will continue to be felt at national parks well after the government reopens.

"Starving the funding for Acadia National Park and national parks through-

PARKS, Page A6

SHUTDOWN DAY 24

10
Failed Senate votes

Sept. 19
Date of last session

594,048
Workers furloughed

35 days
Longest-ever shutdown